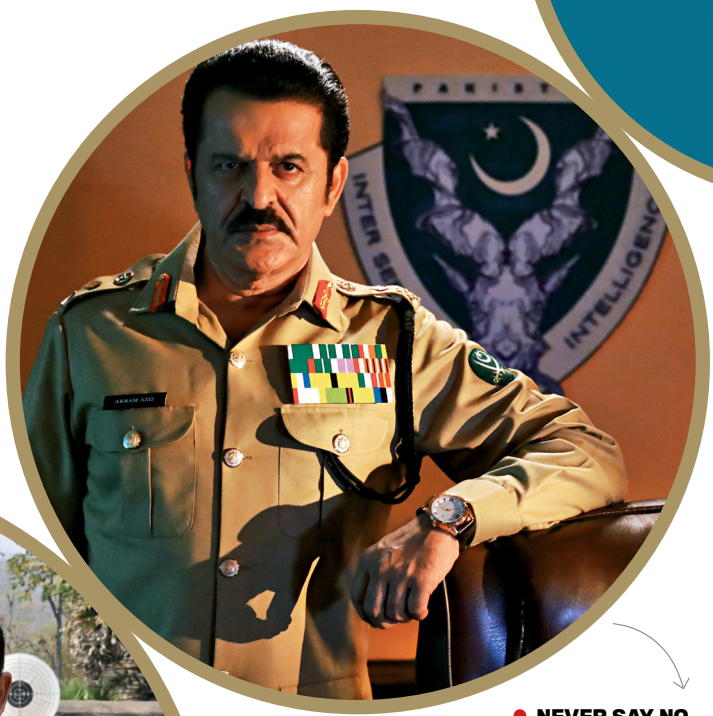
View from the Trenches

Stories about **life in the armed forces** are fast becoming bankable formulas for OTT platforms





NEVER SAY NO
Avrodh S2, featuring adaptions from the book *India's Most Fearless*

When it comes to web shows that depict army life and exploits, filmmaker Raj Acharya is a veteran of sorts. Having directed the limited series *21 Sarfarosh: Saragarhi 1897* (discovery+, 2018) and two seasons of *Avrodh* (SonyLIV, 2020—), Acharya can't seem to get enough of making shows about the Indian Army. "The endeavour at every stage is to make it look different," he says. Given the fresh surge in demand for inspiring narratives about the Indian armed forces, Acharya isn't the only one thriving. There are several others who believe that what works in films like *Uri: The Surgical Strike* (2019), *Kesari* (2019), *Shershaah* (2021) and *Gunjan Saxena* (2020) will work in a longer OTT format, too.



RIGHT ON TARGET
A scene from *Bravehearts*

In June, Dice Media released *Bravehearts* (YouTube), an anthology of short films while SonyLIV unveiled the second season of *Avrodh*, adapting another chapter of Shiv Aroor and Rahul Singh's bestselling book *India's Most Fearless*. In